AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION BOARD

SECONDARY SCHOOL CERTIFICATE

CLASS X EXAMINATION

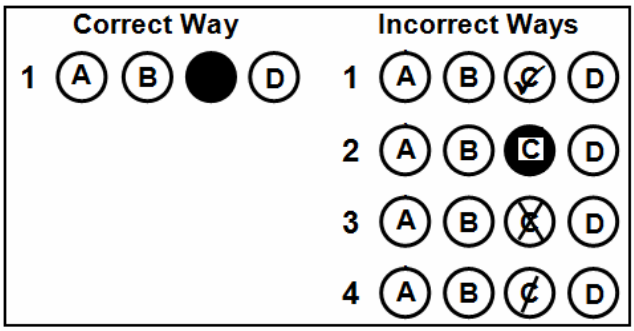
MAY 2013

English Compulsory Paper I

Time: 45 minutes Marks: 25

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Read each question carefully.
2. Answer the questions on the separate answer sheet provided. DO NOT write your answers on the question paper.
3. There are 100 answer numbers on the answer sheet. Use answer numbers 1 to 25 only.
4. In each question there are four choices A, B, C, D. Choose ONE. On the answer grid black out the circle for your choice with a pencil as shown below.



Candidate's Signature

5. If you want to change your answer, ERASE the first answer completely with a rubber, before blacking out a new circle.
6. DO NOT write anything in the answer grid. The computer only records what is in the circles.

Listening Comprehension Section

In this section you will hear two recordings. Each one will be played twice.

Listen carefully to the first recording, and then read the questions. You will have two minutes' reading time.

The recording will then be replayed. You can make notes on your question paper.

When the recording has finished, enter your answers on your separate answer sheet. You will have three and a half minutes to pencil in your answers.

Follow the instruction on the front page of Paper I to show which of the options; A, B, C, or D you have selected for each question.

Listening Passage I

This passage pays a tribute to the cultural heritage of Pakistan as represented by Derawar Fort.

Source: The Daily DAWN

Now listen to the recording.

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

1. The initial part of the passage tells us that Pakistan has

   A. many forts.
   B. rich heritage.
   C. huge forts.
   D. many deserts.

2. The beginning of the passage also indicates that many folk stories have originated from

   A. deserts.
   B. Cholistan.
   C. the traditional places.
   D. northern Pakistan.

3. The author expresses appreciation for the engineers who constructed Derawar fort because

   A. it was a fortified structure.
   B. it gives a feel of strength.
   C. they created the fort without technology.
   D. they created the fort after going through hardships.

4. The fort was created in the ancient times in order to

   A. give Cholistan a stronghold.
   B. protect Cholistan from enemies.
   C. add architectural wonder to Choilstan.
   D. manifest massiveness and glory.

5. The main idea of the entire passage is to

   A. appreciate the forts of Pakistan.
   B. appreciate the architecture of Cholistan.
   C. describe the magnificence of Derawar fort.
   D. celebrate the past of Cholistan.

6. The end of the passage indicates that Derawar fort is

   A. in a relatively good condition.
   B. frequently called a gateway.
   C. a fortified structure which is very big.
   D. affected by the hands of time and weather.

Now, we will play the second recording. It will also be played twice.

Listen carefully to the first playing, then read the questions. You will have two minutes' reading time. The recording will then be replayed.

When the recording has finished, enter your answers on your separate answer sheet. You will have three and a half minutes to pencil in your answers.

Listening Passage II

The passage is about the description of the act of yawning.

Source: Children's Magazine Times of India

Now listen to the recording.

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

7. According to author, it is a popular belief that when people yawn they are feeling

   A. drowsy.
   B. bored.
   C. annoyed.
   D. worried.

8. The passage indicates that both animals and human beings

   A. yawn for the same reason.
   B. yawn when they are hungry.
   C. have the habit of yawning.
   D. are affected by yawning as it is infectious.

9. If you see someone yawning, chances are that you will also start

   A. feeling sleepy.
   B. yawning.
   C. getting bored.
   D. getting tired.

10. New findings about yawning indicate that yawns are a call for

    A. transformation.
    B. observation.
    C. reflection.
    D. execution.

11. The author refers to a research which indicated that primitive human beings yawned when they

    A. were finding unthinkable places.
    B. were infected by contagious diseases.
    C. acquired the tendency to get bored.
    D. wanted to signal for change.

12. The babies yawn in the womb, when they

    A. start growing.
    B. follow suit.
    C. hear something.
    D. change place.

Reading Comprehension Section
You have 20 minutes for this section. This section has two reading passages. You are advised to spend approximately 10 minutes on each of the given passages.
Read the passage carefully and then answer the multiple choice questions that follow:

Reading Passage I

In 1898, fourteen years before the Titanic sank, an American writer named Morgan Robertson wrote a book called 'The Wreck of the Titan.' In his story, the Titan, a passenger ship almost identical to the Titanic, and labelled 'unsinkable,' sails from England headed for New York. The story of the Titan predicted exactly what would happen to the Titanic fourteen years later. It was an eerie prophecy of terrible things to come.

In 1907, nearly ten years after 'The Wreck of the Titan' was written, two men began making plans to build a real titanic ship. At a London dinner party, as they relaxed over coffee and cigars, J. Bruce Ismay, president of the White Star Line of passenger ships, and Lord Pirrie, chairman of Harland and Wolff shipbuilders, discussed a plan to build three enormous ocean liners. Their goal was to give the White Star Line a competitive edge in the Atlantic passenger trade with several gigantic ships whose accommodations would be the last word in comfort and elegance.

The two men certainly dreamed on a grand scale. When these floating palaces were finally built, they were so much bigger than other ships that new docks had to be built on each side of the Atlantic to service them. Four years after that London dinner party, the first of these huge liners, the Olympic, safely completed her maiden voyage.

On May 31, 1911, the hull of the Titanic was launched at the Harland and Wolff shipyards in Belfast, Ireland, before a cheering crowd of 100,000. Bands played, and people came from miles around to see this great wonder of the sea. Twenty-two tons of soap, grease, and train oil were used to slide her into the water.

For the next ten months the Titanic was outfitted and carefully prepared down to the last detail. The final size and richness of this new ship was astounding. She was 882 feet long, almost the length of four city blocks. With nine decks, she was as high as an eleven-story building.

Among her gigantic features, she had four huge funnels, each one big enough to drive two trains through. During construction an astonishing three million rivets had been hammered into her hull. Her three enormous anchors weighed a total of thirty-one tons - the weight of twenty cars. And for her maiden voyage, she carried enough food to feed a small town for several months.

As her name boasted, the Titanic was indeed the biggest ship in the world. Nicknamed "the Millionaires' Special," she was also called "the Wonder Ship," "the Unsinkable Ship," and "the Last Word in Luxury" by newspapers around the world.

Source*: 'Exploring the Titanic'* by Robert D. Ballard

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

13. The phrase 'eerie prophecy' in line 5 means

    A. terrific events.
    B. fearful prediction.
    C. tearful revelation.
    D. natural destination.

14. The similarity between the two ships mentioned in paragraph 1 was that they

    A. both had the same name.
    B. were both unsinkable.
    C. met the same end.
    D. were build by the same organisation.

15. The consequence of the London dinner party was that

    A. a competitive edge was provided for the Atlantic passenger trade.
    B. the last word in comfort and elegance was achieved.
    C. three gigantic ships of great comfort were built.
    D. Harland and Wolff ship builders became the best producers of ships.

16. The phrase 'floating palaces' in line 13 refers to

    A. millionaires.
    B. Titanic and Olympic.
    C. castles of royalty.
    D. luxurious shipbuilders.

17. Which of the following indicates the status of Titanic as a ship unmatched in luxury?

    A. Several musical bands played as Titanic was launched.
    B. Titanic had 22 tons of soap and oil for its passengers.
    C. It was built like a separate state.
    D. It took ten months to furnish Titanic.

18. The time taken to build Titanic was approximately

    A. 14 years.
    B. 10 years.
    C. 4 years.
    D. 5 years.

19. The Titanic was fondly given names by

    A. J. Bruce Ismay.
    B. newspapers.
    C. Lord Pirrie.
    D. millionaires.

Read the passage carefully and then answer the multiple choice questions that follow:

Reading Passage II

Once upon a time all food was organic or naturally grown, it means that farmers mimicked nature's processes.

Essentially it meant that farmers were saving seed and returning crop and kitchen wastes and manure to the soil to be chewed and turned into fresh nutrients by earthworms and scores of other microorganisms. It's a job only these microorganisms can do, and which modern technology can never match. It is biology at work.

This was the time when the only food unsafe to eat was that which was contaminated by unclean water, unhygienic storage, or that which had started rotting. For 10,000 to15, 000 years, farmers had been providing safe, nutritious food. Fruits consumed with their skins could be safely eaten freshly plucked from the tree. All food all over the world was entirely organic… until about half a century ago. In that short period, havoc was wreaked.

Today, eating can be a hazard because food crops are liberally sprayed with chemicals to kill insects that seek to dine on a few plants. Some western scientists felt they could 'improve' on nature by using more chemicals. One erroneously concluded that plants required only three elements (nitrogen, potash and phosphorus) to grow.

That proved to be a blessing for suppliers after the World Wars, saddled with tens of thousands of tons of surplus, unsold chemicals used for ammunition and arms manufacturing. They claimed the same science to market chemicals as the best fertilizers.

To this day, chemicals remain the mainstay of corporations spreading artificial fertilizers around the world. The result has been degradation of the soils worldwide so that millions of acres go permanently out of production every year. That is not all. Poisons have been invented to deal with every kind of pest, rodent, weed, fungi, mildew and mould. What most people do not know is that these poisons were originally designed for warfare.

Source: The Daily DAWN

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

20. Naturally grown food are

A. unsafe to eat.
B. contaminated.
C. safe to eat.
D. full of micro-organisms.

21. The word ‘mimicked’ in line 1 means to

A. blend.
B. imitate.
C. produce.
D. plant.

22. Modern technology can never match

A. farmers.
B. nature’s processes.
C. kitchen’s wastes.
D. biology.

23. 'They' in paragraph 5 line 17 refers to

A. farmers who use technology.
B. western scientists.
C. suppliers after the World Wars.
D. corporations that make fertilizers.

24. What was the blessing for suppliers after the World Wars?

A. They could trade the unsold chemicals as fertilizers.
B. Their unsold chemical could be used as ammunition.
C. They still had a lot of chemicals after the World Wars.
D. Their left-over natural food could be used again.

25. The word 'poisons' in last paragraph refers to

A. infected soil.
B. ammunitions and arcing.
C. micro-organisms.
D. artificial fertilizers.

END OF PAPER

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